A-A-20150
August 4, 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN PARTS, FROZEN, FULLY COOKED, BREADED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-C-44051.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers frozen, fully cooked, breaded chicken parts (drumsticks, thighs, and/or breast halves), packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The frozen, fully cooked chicken parts shall conform to the following types as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Type I - For heating in an oven

Type II - For heating in a deep fat fryer

A. Ingredients. The ingredients used to prepare the product shall be chicken and batter/breading ingredients.

Chicken. Chicken and chicken parts shall be fresh chilled broiler/fryers meeting the requirements of U.S. Grade A for all factors. No previously frozen chicken may be used in this product. The chicken shall weigh not less than 2-1/2 nor more than 3-1/4 pounds without necks and giblets.

Batter/breading ingredients. Only commercially prepared batter/breading ingredients (not artificially colored) commonly used for the type of product specified shall be permitted.

B. Preparation and processing. All preparation and processing described below shall occur subsequent to the date of award. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. Chicken which has been shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) Poultry Products Grading Certificate, certifying quality or grade, class, condition, and processing date.

FSC 8905

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Batter/breading. The cooked chicken parts shall be uniformly coated with batter and breading. All batter and breading shall be applied by machine. Combined batter and breading shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the breaded chicken weight prior to final cooking (frying) and freezing.

Alternative method. The batter/breading ingredients may be applied prior to cooking, provided that, the chicken parts comply with the final product requirements.

Cooking. The chicken parts shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. An internal product temperature of not less than 160°F shall be obtained during cooking. Reworking is not permitted. When cooked in a deep fat fryer, the frying oil shall be continuously filtered and the equipment cleaned on a daily basis. No coconut, palm, or palm kernel oil shall be allowed in the cooking process.

Freezing. The cooked breaded chicken shall be frozen by an individually quick frozen method in accordance with the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations so that individual chicken parts do not stick together after freezing. The frozen, cooked, breaded chicken shall be held at 0°F or below after freezing. The cooked breaded chicken shall be reduced to 0°F or lower within 72 hours of the time the product begins the freezing process. The internal product temperature shall not exceed 0°F at the time of shipment and delivery.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the quality assurance for the frozen, fully cooked, breaded chicken parts, shall be determined by the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, USDA, in accordance with USDA procedures. The product shall be examined and/or tested for conformance to the product requirements in this CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

The cooked breaded parts, as the last step prior to packaging, will be examined by a metal detection device capable of detecting metals that may be present in the product. The examination shall be by (a) a metal detection device operating properly as measured by a detection test strip containing a 440 stainless steel sphere measuring exactly 1.50 mm (0.0591 inch) diameter, (b) presenting the cooked chicken parts one layer thick within the detection field of the device, and (c) procedures appropriate for the depth of the detection field of the device and the sensitivity of the device. The metal detection device shall be one approved by the Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS), USDA. The contractor will provide the prescribed detection test strip for testing the metal detection device under the supervision of USDA. The frequency of testing the metal detection device will be according to the Poultry Division's online acceptable quality level procedure. The guidelines do not relieve the contractor of its responsibility to provide a safe product. Any product suspected of containing or found to contain metal, will be handled according to and the disposition of the product determined by FSIS procedures.

Product requirements. The product shall comply with the following requirements:

1. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, glass, or metal.

2. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

3. There shall be no color(s) foreign to the product.

4. Combined batter and breading shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the breaded chicken part weight.

5. Individual areas of missing breading or incompletely cooked breading on a part may not exceed an area equivalent to three-fourths of a square inch or the area of a circle approximately 1 inch in diameter.

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6. Aggregate area of all missing breading on a part may not exceed an area equivalent to 1-1/2 square inches or the area of a circle approximately 1-1/2 inches in diameter.

7. After cooking, there shall be no burnt (scorched) area on a chicken part greater than 1/4 inch in any dimension.

8. After freezing when Type I product is reheated in an oven or Type II product is reheated in a deep fat fryer, according to the contractor's instruction, the chicken pieces shall be uniform golden brown in color with no scorched area, and the coating shall be crisp and not soggy. The color shall be determined by USDA online and at a USDA inspection facility just prior to shipment by the vendor to the using or contracting organization. A uniform golden brown color is no lighter in color than the light tolerance nor darker than the dark tolerance shown in the USDA, AMS, Poultry Division color control guidelines dated June 1987 for breaded chicken examples.

9. When reheated according to the contractor's instructions, the flavor and odor shall be typical of chicken of the same type and the texture shall be tender and juicy.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The chicken parts shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with good commercial practice. Thirty-six pieces _ one piece of one part (breast halves, thighs, or drumsticks) of one type only shall be packaged in a 2 mil thick plastic bag. The bag shall be sealed. Metal wire ties or staples shall not be used to seal bag. Each individual sample bag must meet the _ 1 part count tolerance, and the average number of pieces per bag within each master container must meet or exceed 36 pieces. (Sample applies to hourly samples or stationary lot samples.)

B. Commercial packing. Three bags, each of which must contain 36 _ one piece (one bag each of breast halves, thighs, and drumsticks) shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be

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in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. The bags shall be sealed. Metal wire ties or staples shall not be used to seal bag. The average number of pieces per bag within each master container must meet or exceed 36 pieces.

C. Export packaging. Thirty-six pieces _ one piece of one part (breast halves, thighs, or drumsticks) of one type only shall be packaged in a plastic bag (at least 2 mil low-density polyethylene or its equivalent). The bag shall be sealed. Metal wire ties or staples shall not be used to seal bag. Each individual sample bag must meet the _ 1 part count tolerance, and the average number of pieces per bag within each master container must meet or exceed 36 pieces. (Sample applies to hourly samples or stationary lot samples.)

D. Export packing. Three bags, each of which must contain 36 _ one piece (one bag each of breast halves, thighs, and drumsticks) shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with PPP-B-636, Class weather-resistant, Grade W5c or W5s, Style FTC. Alternatively, the box shall be a wax-impregnated box conforming to PPP-B-1163, Style RSC, Class 1, Type SWCFI, Grade 200, and closed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape. The bags shall be sealed. Metal wire ties or staples shall not be used to seal bag. The average number of pieces per bag within each master container must meet or exceed 36 pieces.

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

G. Marking. Marking of the shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

The Poultry Products Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Part 381. Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. These publications may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the Color Control Guidelines for Breaded Chicken may be obtained from:

Director
Poultry Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 3932, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairman
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

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Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B036

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